TECHNICAL SUPPORT

Driver & Software Support

Drivers and system software allow computer hardware to communicate with the operating system and installed applications. Keeping essential software compatible and reasonably up to date can improve stability, security, and support for newer hardware and games.

This document explains how customers can manage drivers, operating system updates, and common software problems on Windows-based gaming computers.

What Is a Device Driver?

A device driver is software that enables the operating system to communicate with a hardware component.

Graphics cards, network adapters, audio devices, printers, and many other components require drivers to function correctly.

Windows includes drivers for a wide range of hardware, but some devices benefit from additional software supplied by the manufacturer.

Incorrect, outdated, or incompatible drivers can cause reduced functionality, instability, or unexpected errors.

Graphics Card Drivers

Graphics drivers are especially important for gaming performance and compatibility with modern games.

Manufacturers such as NVIDIA, AMD, and Intel provide drivers for their supported graphics hardware.

Customers should obtain graphics drivers from official manufacturer websites or trusted update tools supplied by the manufacturer.

New driver versions may include security fixes, bug corrections, and optimizations for specific games. However, updating a driver does not guarantee improved performance in every application.

If a new driver causes problems, customers may need to reinstall a previous stable version following the manufacturer's instructions.

Motherboard and Chipset Drivers

Chipset drivers help the operating system communicate with important motherboard functions and system controllers.

Depending on the motherboard, additional drivers may be required for networking, audio, wireless connectivity, or other integrated devices.

Customers should identify the exact motherboard model before downloading drivers. Installing software intended for a different motherboard may cause compatibility problems.

Motherboard manufacturers normally provide a support page containing drivers and technical documentation for each model.

Windows Updates

Windows Update provides operating system security updates, reliability improvements, and some device drivers.

PixelForge recommends keeping supported Windows installations updated, particularly when updates address known security vulnerabilities.

Customers should save open work before installing updates that require a restart.

Some updates may temporarily affect software compatibility. If a problem begins immediately after an update, customers should review the update history and consult official Microsoft support guidance.

Installing Software Safely

Customers should download applications from official developers, established software stores, or other trustworthy sources.

Unknown download websites may distribute modified installers, unwanted applications, or malicious software.

Customers should be cautious when an installer requests administrator privileges or attempts to install unrelated software.

Antivirus and other security protections should remain enabled unless a trusted troubleshooting procedure specifically requires a temporary change.

Resolving Software Conflicts

Software conflicts may occur when applications attempt to control the same hardware functions or install incompatible background services.

Examples include multiple RGB lighting utilities, overlapping hardware monitoring tools, or outdated applications that interact with graphics drivers.

Customers experiencing crashes should identify whether the problem occurs in one application or across the entire operating system.

Temporarily disabling recently installed background applications may help identify the cause. Customers should avoid removing essential system services or security software without understanding the consequences.

BIOS and Firmware Updates

A BIOS or UEFI update may improve hardware compatibility, resolve known issues, or add support for newer processors.

Firmware updates should only be downloaded from the official manufacturer and must match the exact hardware model.

Interrupting a firmware update can make a motherboard or other device unusable. Customers should follow the manufacturer's instructions carefully and ensure a stable power supply during the process.

A BIOS update is not necessary simply because a newer version exists. Customers should review the release notes and determine whether the update addresses a relevant issue.

Reinstalling Windows

Reinstalling Windows may resolve severe software corruption or persistent operating system problems, but it should generally be considered after less disruptive troubleshooting options.

A reinstall may remove installed applications, custom settings, and personal files depending on the chosen method.

Customers should back up important information before beginning and verify that they have access to necessary installation media, accounts, and software licenses.

PixelForge cannot guarantee recovery of files that were not backed up before a system reset or storage replacement.

Software Support and Warranty Coverage

PixelForge can provide general assistance with operating system startup, driver installation, and software problems affecting supported hardware.

However, support for third-party applications, game modifications, unsupported operating systems, and individually customized software environments may be limited.

Software problems do not automatically indicate a hardware defect. A warranty assessment may require troubleshooting to determine whether the underlying cause is hardware or software related.

For hardware warranty conditions, see Warranty Policy.

Preparing Information for Support

When contacting PixelForge about a software issue, customers should provide the computer model, Windows version, affected application, and a description of the symptoms.

Error messages, driver versions, and the approximate time the problem began can also help with diagnosis.

Customers should never send passwords, recovery codes, or other sensitive credentials in ordinary support messages.

For general PC troubleshooting, see Troubleshooting Your PC. For instructions on submitting a support request, consult Contacting Technical Support.